

Putting your Video on the Web

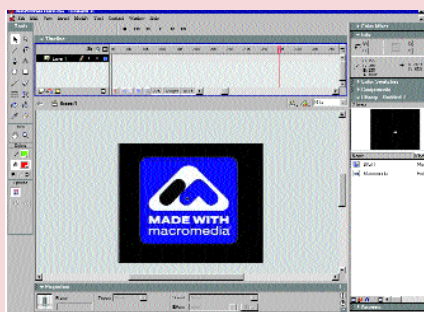
Converting your AVI, MPG and Quick Time files to SWF format before publishing them to your Web site can result in considerable space savings and visitors to your site will be able to watch the movie directly in their Web browser (provided they have the correct plugin).

STEP 1 Click **Insert > New symbol**. You will be prompted for the type of symbol you want to create. Select **Movie Clip** from the **Behavior** options.

STEP 2 Under **File > Import**, select the video file that you want to import. At the **Import Video** prompt, select 'Embed video in Macromedia Flash document' and click **OK**.

STEP 3 In the 'Import video settings' window, change the scale setting from 100 per cent to 80 per cent in order to compress the video to a decent quality. You can also adjust the quality of your video file—we have changed the default quality setting from 50 to 80. After the file is imported, click **Yes** to embed the video file on the timeline. Save the file on your PC.

STEP 4 Click on the **Scene 1** button that resides just below the **Timeline**



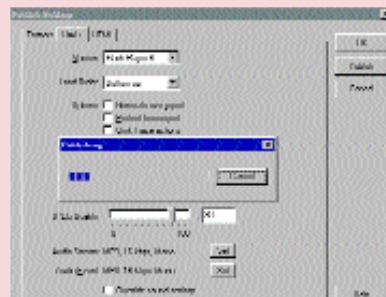
Select the imported movie from the **Library** panel and drag it to the work area

panel. Drag the movie clip symbol from the **Library** panel to the work area of **Scene 1** (the **Library** panel can be enabled by pressing [F11])

STEP 5 Reset the size of your work area to match the size of the imported video file by clicking on **Modify > Document** and set the **Dimensions** according to the movie size. The **Info** panel (enabled by pressing [Ctrl] + [I]) will show you the size of the imported video file.

STEP 6 Go to **File > Publish Settings** and select the **Flash** and **HTML** box in the **Format** tab. Click on the **Flash** tab and

with **Flash Player 6** selected from the **Version** drop down box, click on the **Publish** button.



Publishing your video

STEP 7 Browse to the folder in which you saved the Flash file. You will find that two files have been saved—one is in the **HTML** format and the other is an **SWF** file. Upload both files on your Web server using an **FTP** program (such as **CuteFTP**) and link the **HTML** file to any of the pages on your Web site.

Note: In case the video file is in **MPG/MPEG** or **QuickTime 4** format, it will not import the audio along with the movie in **Flash**. Even a video file of 1 to 2 MB will take at least 5-10 minutes to import on slower machines.

Developing rich Internet applications with **Macromedia Flash MX** is made easier with the addition of **Macromedia Flash Remoting** components. With **Macromedia Flash Remoting**, developers can easily connect **ActionScript** client logic directly to remote services without writing any extra code. It enables **Flash MX** to exchange data with remote services, including **ColdFusion** components, **EJBs**, **Java** classes, and **.NET** components and pages.



Sitespring allows for efficient project management amongst Web developers

To help ease development in highly managed production environments, **Flash MX** integrates directly with **Site-spring**, **Macromedia's** workflow manage-

ment server. **Sitespring** users can check content in and out, update status, and communicate with their teams without leaving **Flash**.

One major complaint from most users was that using too much **XML** code would kill the animation. This problem has been addressed and **Flash MX** uses **XML** more efficiently, resulting in smoother animation.

The verdict

So, is **Flash MX** truly worth the upgrade? The revamped user interface alone can provide a huge boost to your productivity, and the new design and development features are a big plus while developing either animations or rich media-based Web applications. However, in spite of these new enhancements, one wonders why there are no graphical tools to support basic 3D modelling. If you use **Flash** primarily as an animation tool, then there's no compelling reason to upgrade from version 5. **Flash MX** boasts huge functional advancements when it comes

Flash MX

Performance	▶▶▶▶▶
Ease of use	▶▶▶▶▶
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶
Features	▶▶▶▶▶
OVERALL	▶▶▶▶▶

Price: Rs 24,950

Contact: Macromedia

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Web site: www.macromedia.com

SYSTEM REQUIREMENTS:

200 MHz Intel Pentium processor, Windows 98 SE/Me/NT4/2000/XP, 64 MB RAM (128 MB recommended), 85 MB hard disk space, 1024x768 resolution, 16-bit colour display or better, CD-ROM drive

to programming and if you intend to develop games, Web-based applications and multimedia interfaces, then you would definitely benefit from migrating to **Flash MX**. ■

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